

Where to build, what to pay, and what to ignore

Five decisions distilled from 1,000 live SaaS-startup listings — for anyone allocating time, capital, or attention into indie/micro-SaaS.

1,000

startups tracked

64

countries represented

\$133.8M

combined 12-month revenue

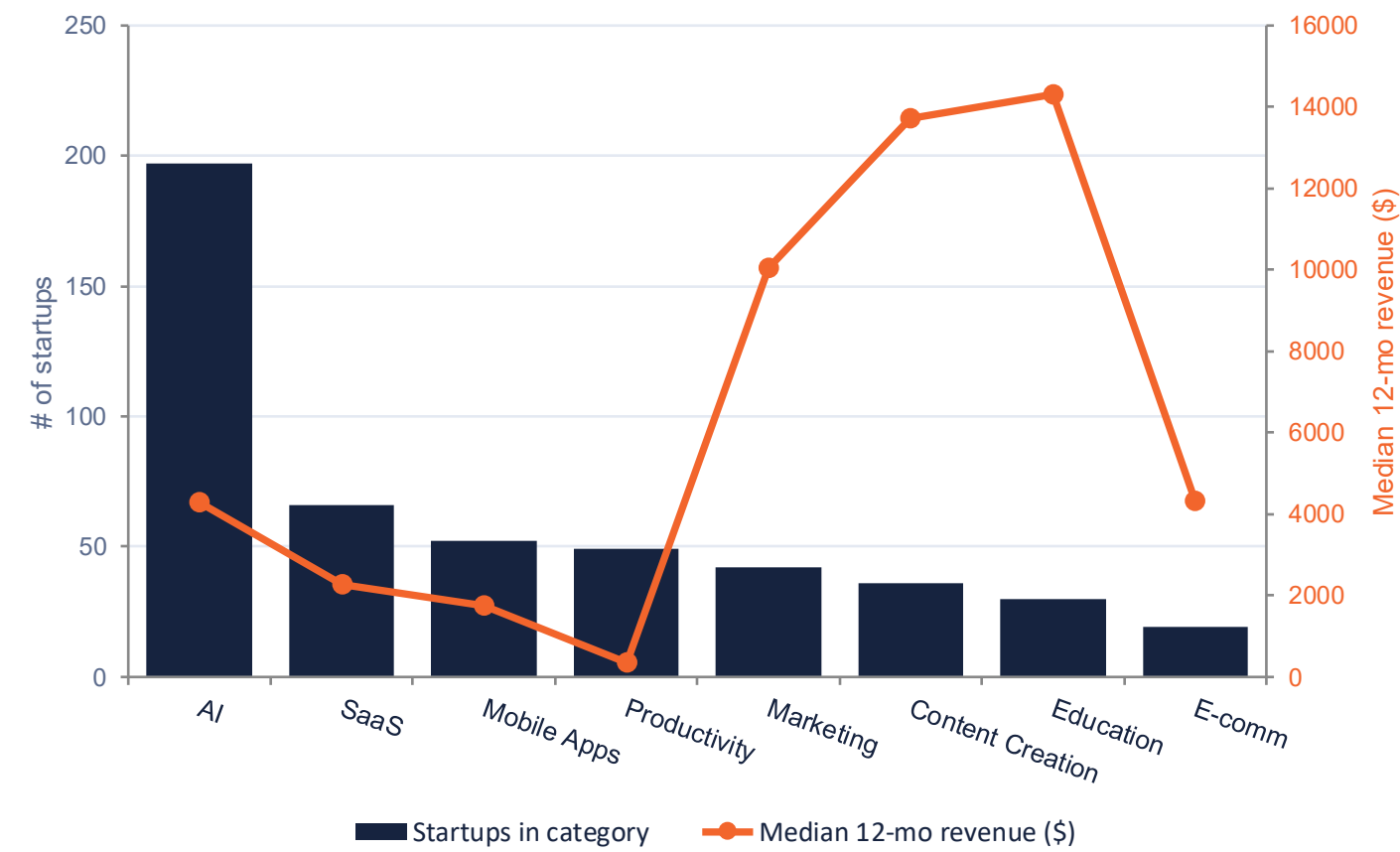
262

priced acquisition listings

Read as: what to do next — not just what happened.

Don't build where everyone else already is

Startup count vs. median 12-month revenue, by category



What the gap means

AI

197 startups, \$4.3K median — the most crowded, least differentiated lane. Enter only with a sharp wedge.

Marketing / Education

Under 45 startups each, but 3–4x the median revenue of AI. Smaller field, stronger economics.

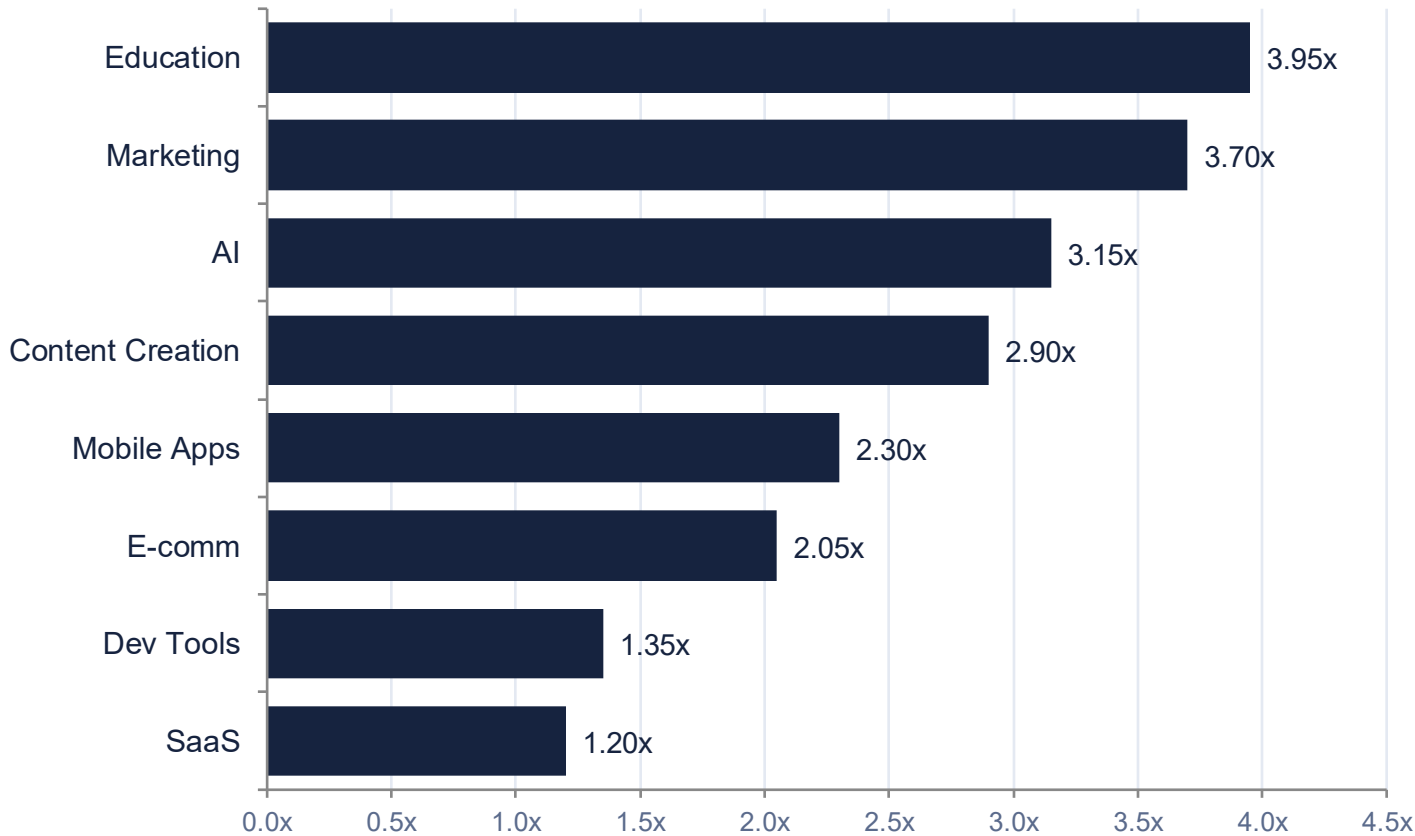
Productivity

49 startups, just \$350 median revenue — a graveyard of unmonetized side-projects.

! **Decision:** Weight category choice by revenue-per-entrant, not headcount — chase where competitors are thin and checks are real.

Anchor deals to the median — the average lies to you

Median revenue multiple by category, across 262 priced listings



Median vs. mean (n = 262)

2.30x
median — the real benchmark

7.77x
mean — skewed by outliers to 300x+

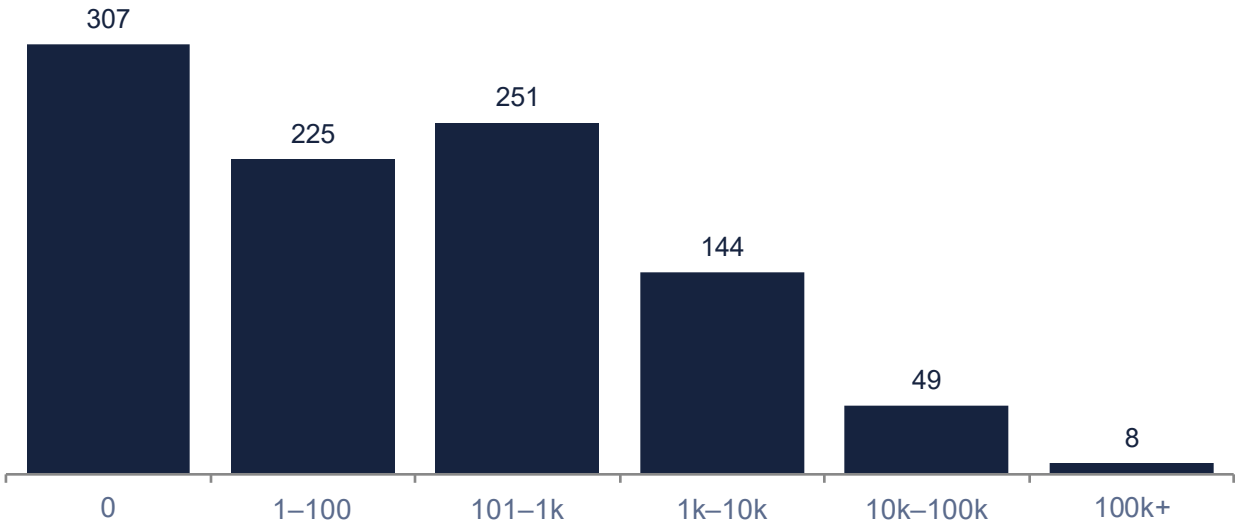
Cheapest → priciest entry points

SaaS at 1.2x is the cheapest way into recurring revenue in this dataset. Education at 3.95x commands the steepest premium — buyers are pricing in retention, not hype.

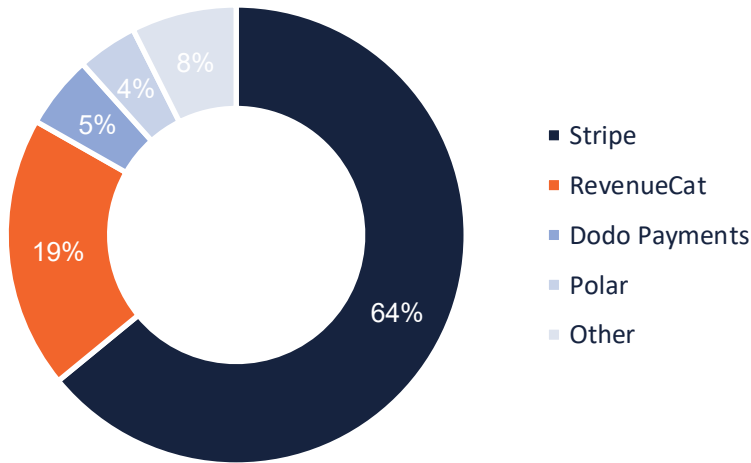
Decision: Walk into any negotiation quoting the category median (not the headline average) — it's your realistic ceiling.

Followers are noise. Payment stack is signal.

X (Twitter) followers vs. revenue



Payment provider — share of mentions



r = 0.03 correlation between follower count and 12-month revenue — statistically nothing.

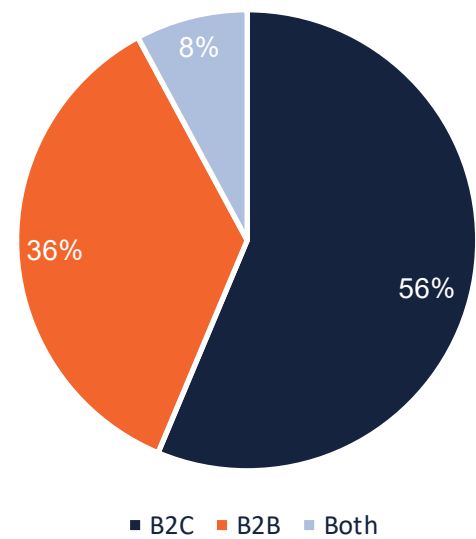
31% of listed startups have zero followers — including several of the highest earners in the set.

65% run on Stripe
— the default, low-risk choice. RevenueCat (19%) is a reliable tell for mobile-subscription apps when triaging deal flow fast.

! **Decision:** Drop follower count from your screening checklist entirely; use payment provider as a 5-second business-model filter instead.

Price for the creator economy, not the enterprise

Audience type across all listings



Persona language repeats the same words: **creators, freelancers, agencies, small teams, founders.**

MRR benchmark by category (use as a pricing anchor)

Category	n	Median MRR
Education	30	\$2,142
Marketing	42	\$1,586
Analytics	19	\$1,294
Social Media	18	\$912
AI	197	\$446
SaaS	66	\$303
E-comm	19	\$155
Productivity	49	\$42



Decision: Skip enterprise-style pricing and long sales cycles — design self-serve pricing around the \$150–\$2,100 MRR band your category actually clears.